

# Why Gender Diversity Leads to Success



Gender diversity is a hot topic — companies are looking for smarter ways to build a diverse workforce. Diversity helps build a stronger reputation and brand, increases the volume and quality of potential new employees, and brings a diversity of skills and perspectives that companies increasingly need to stay competitive.

Companies with a gender-balanced workforce have consistently demonstrated stronger economic and social outcomes. Although some industries have made significant progress, IT continues to lag behind.

## Why hire more women?

Women strengthen team dynamics, uniting people and drawing together opinions to optimise decision-making. A diverse workforce better reflects a company's client base — Forbes data shows women worldwide influence up to 80% of purchase decisions. McKinsey estimates that if women worked at their full economic potential, they would add \$28 trillion to global GDP by 2025. A 2014 MIT study found that companies with lower gender polarisation increased revenue by as much as 41%.

## How to attract more women

Job ads should reflect an inclusive and welcoming culture. Listings should mention collaborative working styles, interpersonal skills and flexible working hours. Companies should implement leadership and skills development programmes for women, be transparent about maternity policies, and include more women in the actual hiring process — all of which immediately signals cultural commitment.